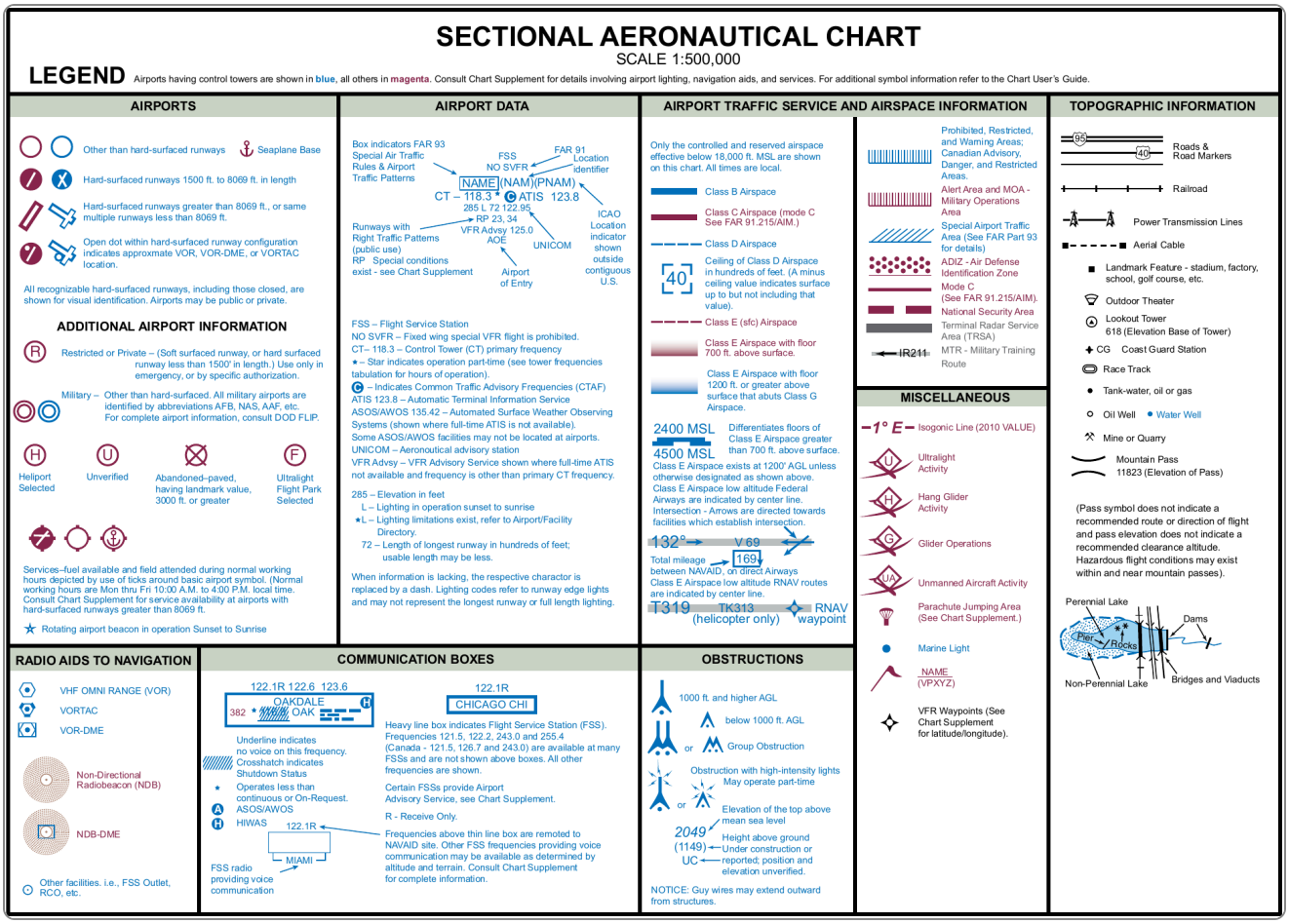
Sectional chart legend

Edition Oct 2026

The legend on your test

This is the legend page in the FAA testing supplement for the commercial test.



FAA-CT-8080-1E, Legend 1 (2018).

Changed since 2018: the Airport/Facility Directory is now the Chart Supplement, and a real chart's isogonic lines follow the current five-year magnetic variation model. The test still uses this page.

Symbols a balloon pilot reads most

A	**Obstruction** above 200 and below 1,000 ft AGL (above 299 ft in urban areas). One 1,000 ft AGL or higher gets a taller symbol.
	Power transmission line: a line broken by small tower symbols. A line with cross ticks is a railroad.
	Class C: solid magenta band.
	Class E to the surface: dashed magenta line.
	Class E from 1,200 ft AGL or higher, next to Class G: blue shading.
2049 (1149)	**Top is 2,049 ft MSL**; the number in parentheses is its height above ground (1,149 ft AGL).
	Class B: solid blue band.
	Class D: dashed blue line. A boxed number like [25] is its ceiling in hundreds of feet MSL.
	Class E from 700 ft AGL: magenta shading, fading toward the inside.
	Airport colors: blue airports have a control tower; magenta ones do not.

Sources: FAA-CT-8080-1E Legend 1, FAA Aeronautical Chart Users' Guide (Jul 2026). Original card, not an FAA document.

Study aid, not for navigation.